
Selling methods

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Solution selling is a customer-focused approach where the salesperson acts like a consultant: they diagnose the buyer's specific problems or needs first, then tailor a combination of products or services to solve them. It shifts from pushing features to solving pain points.3fcf5e
Insight selling involves leading with fresh, data-backed ideas or perspectives that the buyer hasn't considered. Instead of just responding to stated needs, you educate them on hidden problems, opportunities, or better ways to think about their challenges to create demand and drive change.f8df66

SPIN selling is a questioning framework developed by Neil Rackham. SPIN stands for:

Situation — gather background info

Problem — uncover pain points

Implication — explore the consequences of those problems

Need-payoff — get the buyer to articulate the value of solving it

It helps sellers guide conversations through targeted questions rather than pitching.cc4151

The Challenger method (or Challenger Sale) teaches, tailors, and takes control of the sales conversation. Challengers push back on the buyer's assumptions, share unique insights that reframe their problems, and confidently guide them to a solution. It's less about building rapport and more about bringing new ideas and maintaining control.72dda5

MEDDPICC (often stylized as MEDDPICC) is a qualification framework used in complex B2B sales to assess deal health and forecast accuracy. It stands for:

Metrics — quantifiable business impact

Economic Buyer — the person with budget authority

Decision Criteria — what they evaluate

Decision Process — how and when they'll decide

Paper Process — the steps to get the contract signed

Identify Pain — the problems driving the need

Champion — an internal advocate who sells for you

Competition — any other options or internal projects competing for resources

It's essentially a checklist to make sure nothing critical is missing from the deal.60c9d9

These methods often overlap—Challenger and insight selling share DNA, and both build on the problem-focused foundation of solution and SPIN selling—but each has a distinct emphasis.

Yes, there is actual challenging — but it's not about being rude or confrontational.

In the Challenger method, you directly challenge the buyer's current thinking, assumptions, and view of their own problems. You teach them something new about their business that they hadn't fully realized, reframe their issues as bigger or different than they thought, and push them to see why their status quo is more dangerous or costly than they appreciate.c54a6f

The goal is to create "constructive tension" — making the buyer uncomfortable with their existing situation, not with you. You tell them what should be keeping them up at night instead of asking what is. It's assertive: you debate, push back on their objections or outdated views, and take control of the conversation.

It's very different from solution selling or SPIN, where you mostly follow the buyer's lead and ask questions to uncover needs. Challenger flips it — you lead with insight to change how they see their world.

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